

Deployment Guide for Gender Cell Website (IITK)

This guide provides step-by-step instructions on how to update and deploy the Gender Cell website to the IIT Kanpur institutional server.

1. Prerequisites

- **Node.js & npm:** Installed on your local machine.
 - **VPN:** If you are off-campus, you must be connected to the IITK VPN to access the server.
 - **SFTP Credentials:** Username (web_gc) and your password.
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2. Steps to Build and Deploy

Step 1: Build the Project

Open your terminal in the project root folder (website_gender_cell) and run:

```
npm run build
```

- This creates (or updates) the `dist/` folder.
- **Note:** All internal links and PDF paths are already configured to work in the `/gc/` subfolder.

Step 2: Verify Locally (Optional but Recommended)

Test the production build before uploading it:

```
npm run preview
```

- Open the resulting link (usually `http://localhost:4173`).
- Check that the URLs look like `.../#/about` and that PDFs open correctly.

Step 3: Connect to the Server

Use SFTP to connect to the IITK webhome server:

```
sftp web_gc@oweb.iitk.ac.in
```

- Enter your password when prompted.

Step 4: Clear Old Files (If Necessary)

If you want to ensure a clean deployment, you can remove the old assets folder first (be careful!):

```
rm -rf assets
```

Step 5: Upload the New Code

You must upload the **contents** of the `dist/` folder, not the folder itself:

```
put -r dist/*
```

- This will upload `index.html` , the `assets/` folder, and the `pdf/` folder directly into your root directory.

Step 6: Verify the Live Site

Visit: <https://iitk.ac.in/gc/>

3. Important Notes

Subfolder Compatibility

The project is configured with `base: './'` in `vite.config.js`. This allows it to run correctly under the `/gc/` path. Do **not** change this to `/`.

Hash Routing

We use `HashRouter`. This means:

- Your URLs will contain a `#` (e.g., `iitk.ac.in/gc/#/about`).
- This is necessary because institutional servers do not allow custom URL rewriting needed for standard routing.
- **Internal Links:** Always use the `<Link>` component in React instead of `<a>` tags for internal pages.

PDF Management

- All PDFs are stored in `public/pdf`.
- They are referenced in `src/setups/pdfExports.js` using relative paths (`pdf/filename.pdf`).
- **If you add a new PDF:** Put it in `public/pdf` and add it to the list in `pdfExports.js`.

Disk Quota

- Your account (`web_gc`) has a **250 MB limit**.
- Currently, the PDFs are compressed to save space (~94MB total).

- Check your space using: `ssh web_gc@oweb.iitk.ac.in "quota -s"`
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4. Troubleshooting

- **404 Errors on Assets:** Ensure you uploaded the `assets/` folder correctly inside the root.
 - **PDFs Not Opening:** Ensure the `pdf/` folder is present on the server.
 - **Changes Not Appearing:** Clear your browser cache or open the site in Incognito mode.
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5. SFTP & Terminal Cheat Sheet

Here are the most common commands you will need for managing files on the server.

Navigation (Moving Around)

- `pwd` : Show current directory on the **server**.
- `1pwd` : Show current directory on your **local computer**.
- `ls` : List files on the **server**.
- `1ls` : List files on your **local computer**.
- `cd <folder>` : Move into a folder on the **server**.
- *Example:* `cd assets`
- `cd ..` : Move “out” or “up” one level.

Managing Files

- `put <file>` : Upload a file from local to server.

- *Example:* `put index.html`
- **`put -r <folder>`** : Upload an entire folder and everything inside it.
- *Example:* `put -r assets`
- **`get <file>`** : Download a file from server to local.
- *Example:* `get robots.txt`
- **`rm <file>`** : Delete a file on the server.
- *Example:* `rm test.html`
- **`mv <old_name> <new_name>`** : Rename a file or move it.
- *Example:* `mv old_index.html index.html`

Managing Folders

- **`mkdir <name>`** : Create a new folder.
- *Example:* `mkdir backup`
- **`rmdir <name>`** : Delete an **empty** folder.
- *Example:* `rmdir old_folder`
- **`rm -rf <name>`** : (SSH only) Delete a folder and **everything inside it**. Use with caution!
- *Example (from normal terminal):* `ssh web_gc@oweb.iitk.ac.in "rm -rf /users/web_gc/old_site"`
- *Note:* In SFTP, you must delete the files inside a folder before you can delete the folder.

How to use SSH for fast cleanup

If you need to delete a lot of files or a whole folder at once, it is faster to use SSH:

```
ssh web_gc@oweb.iitk.ac.in "rm -rf /users/web_gc/assets"
```

(This deletes the old assets folder in one second so you can upload a fresh one).